

Decision-making guide

Human Resource Management Simulation

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1. Simulation platform introduction

1.1 Game Arena

The gaming arena interface comprises various decision tabs that includes market, Talent acquisition, Talent Management, Organization & Budget, Decision Checklist, and the Report. Some sections must be completed first as they have an impact on other areas.

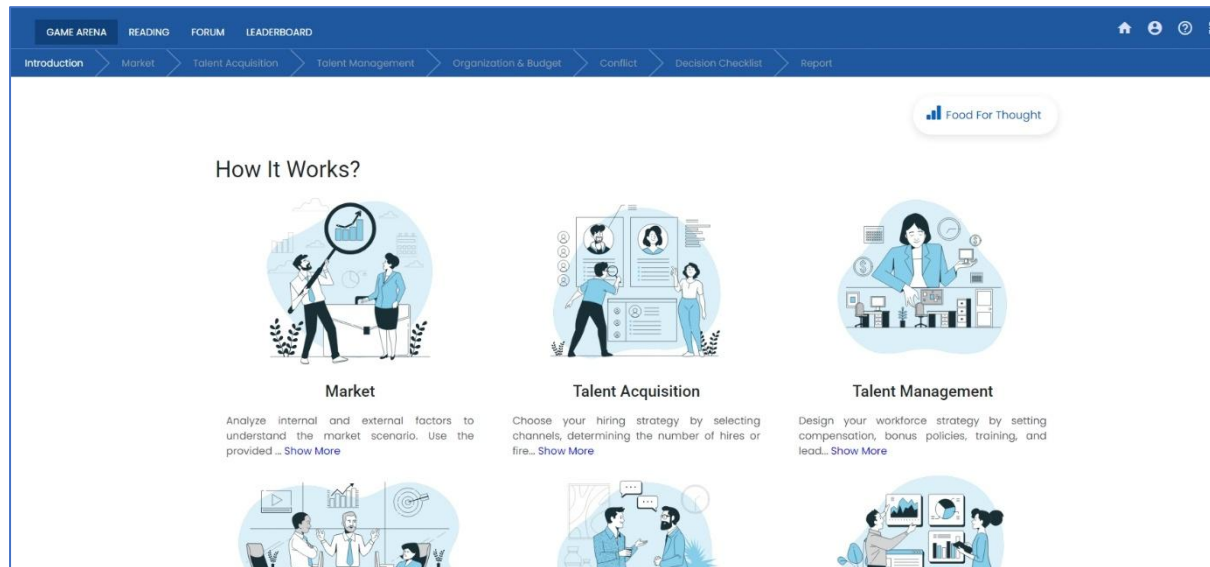


Figure 1 The Game Arena

1.2 Readings

This section provides essential materials necessary for participants to actively engage in the game. The main reading material consists of a guide for decision-making, supplemented by optional additional resources chosen by instructors. Moreover, a walkthrough video is accessible, offering in-depth information about the scenario featured in the simulation. This video presents insights into the industry, ongoing trends, obstacles, and the diverse array of decisions required.

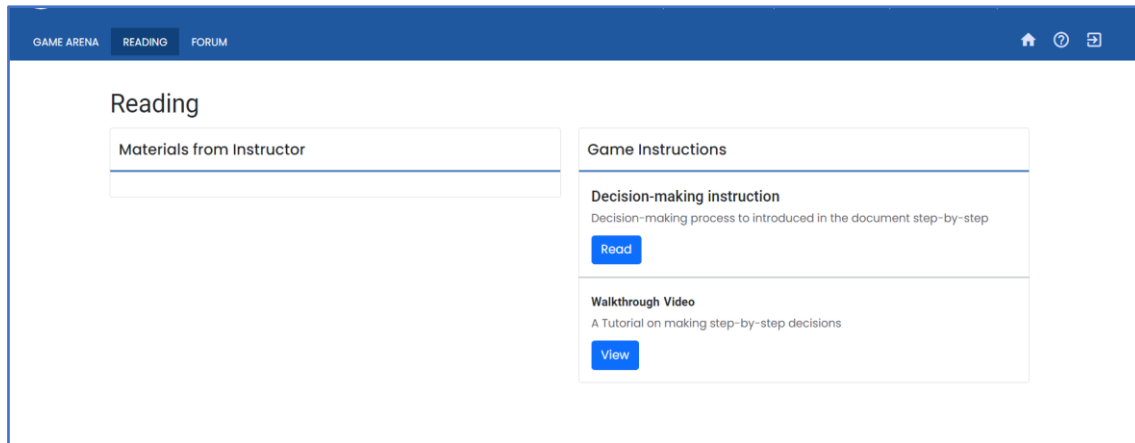


Figure 2 The Readings Section

1.3 Forum

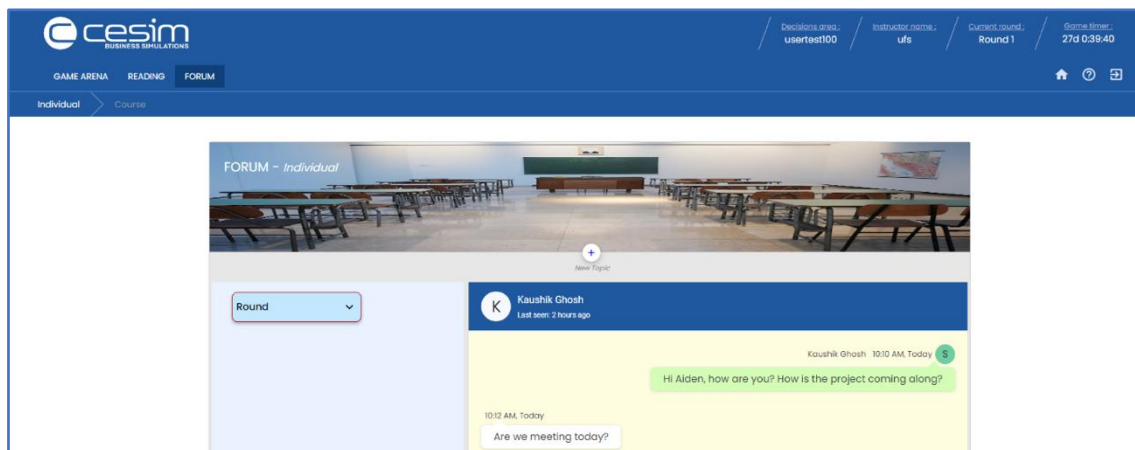


Figure 3 The Forum Section

- The forums provide an excellent platform for participants to engage with their instructors or peers.
- There are two separate forums: the Individual Forum and the Course Forum. The Individual Forum allows participants to communicate directly with the instructor, while the Course Forum is accessible to all enrolled players.
- Instructors can view and respond to posts in both sections. Consequently, the Course Forum is an appropriate space for asking questions that can benefit the entire course, while the Individual Forum is the preferred channel for the individual to have a direct discussion with the professor.
- Participants will receive notifications for messages.

1.4 Main Objective & Winning Criteria

The HRM Simulation is meticulously designed to enhance participants' understanding and decision-making skills in three key areas: **Talent Acquisition, Talent Management, Effectiveness & Budgets**. The simulation is structured to encourage collaboration within teams while fostering healthy competition among different teams. Over five rounds (or financial years), teams are tasked with navigating diverse economic conditions and making sustainable decisions that balance immediate needs with long-term goals.

Success in the simulation is measured by the improvement of two critical Key Performance Indicators (KPIs): *Stakeholder Satisfaction and Employee Satisfaction Scores*. By demonstrating adaptability and strategic foresight in responding to economic challenges, participants should strive to make thoughtful, data-driven choices that enhance overall organizational performance. This is achieved through the effective management of budgets, resources, and talent across all four divisions.

1.5 Successful decision-making flow

The sequence of decision-making unfolds as follows:

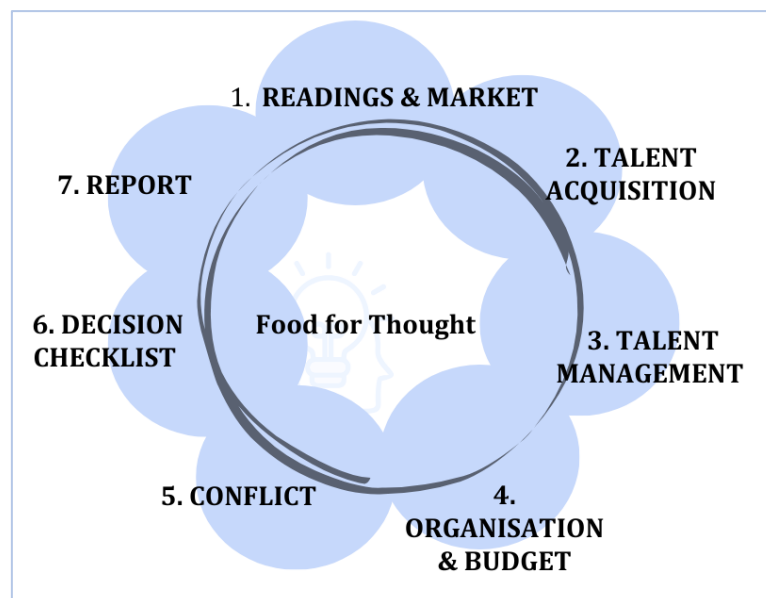


Figure 4 The Sequence of Decision-Making Process

2. Game Arena

2.1 Introduction

This page encompasses information detailing the functioning of the simulation and provides insights into each tab's decision-making.

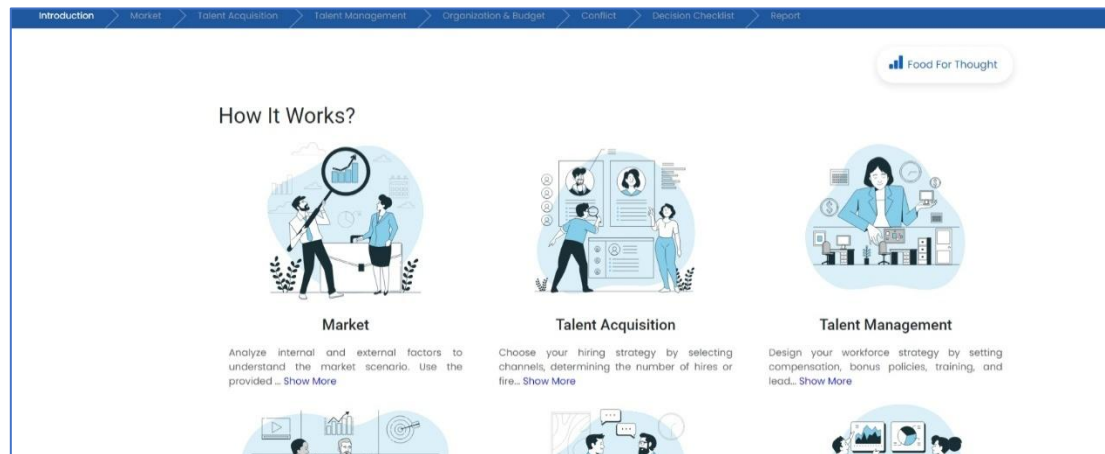


Figure 5 The Introduction Tab

2.2 Food for Thought

This segment provides crucial aspects to consider, offering valuable insights for decision-making.

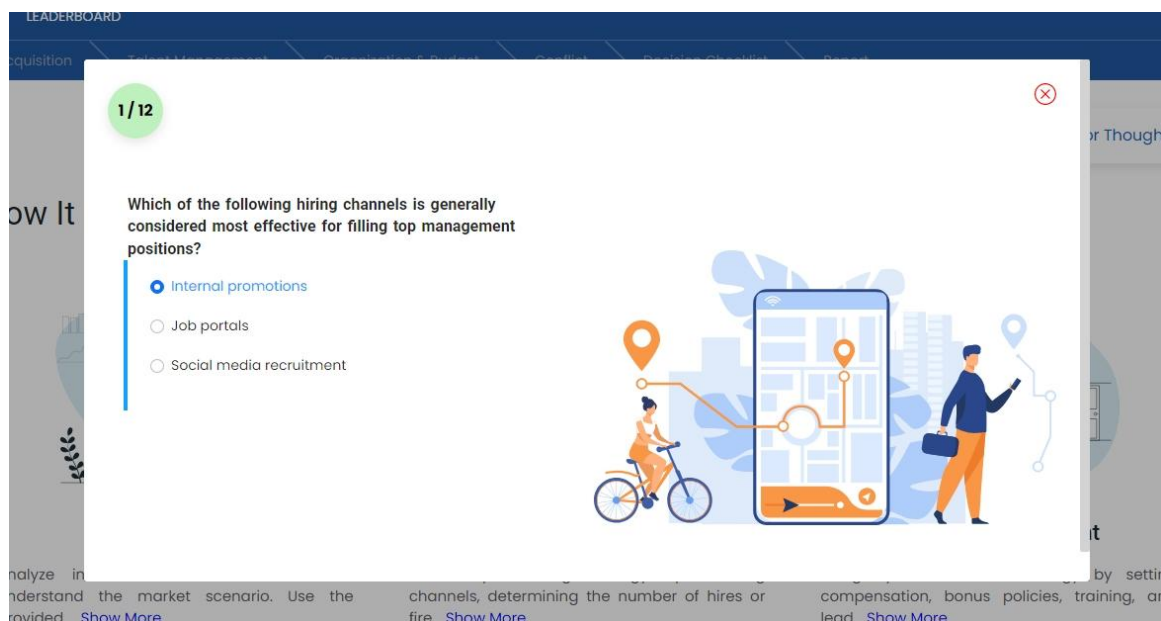


Figure 6 The food for Thought Section

2.3 Market

Prior to commencing the decision-making process, it is essential to carefully examine the "Market" section. This section offers vital information on case scenario, and the key parameters to consider when making decisions in each tab.

This section discusses the micro and macro environmental factors that impact businesses. As economic conditions shift, businesses must adapt accordingly, necessitating appropriate actions by their HR divisions.

Round 1: Business is Booming

Round 2: Growth continues

Round 3: The contraction cycle starts

Round 4: Recession hits in

Round 5: Business coming back to normal

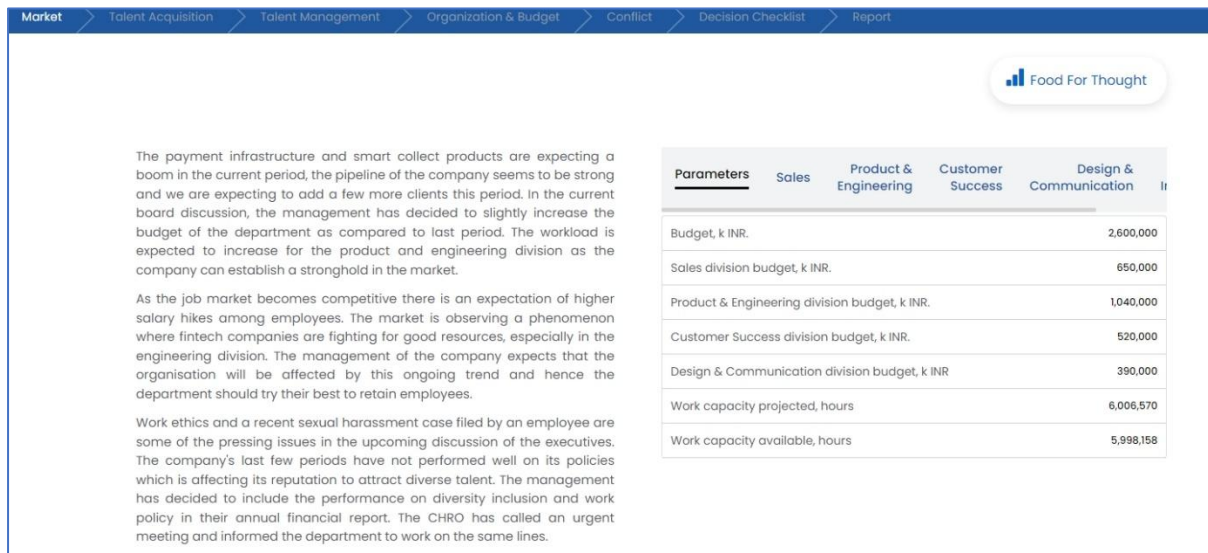


Figure 7 The Market Section

The parameters outline how changes in business conditions influence the budget, salary hikes, attrition rates, and other factors, all of which are shaped by decisions made in the previous year. Participants must take into account both the overall general parameters and the specific parameters provided for each department individually.

2.4 Talent Acquisition

Hiring Channel	Top Management		Senior Management		Junior Management	
	Current Year	Previous Year	Current Year	Previous Year	Current Year	Previous Year
Chanel 1	Executive Hiring	Vendor General Hiring	Direct Hiring	Direct Hiring	Campus Hiring	Campus Hiring
Chanel 2	Vendor General	Executive Hiring	Employee Refe	Employee Referral	Employee Refe	Employee Referral
Chanel 3	Select	Campus Hiring	Select	Campus Hiring	Select	Campus Hiring

Figure 8 The Talent Acquisition Tab

The available channels include:

Campus Hiring: Recruiting fresh graduates directly from educational institutions to bring in young talent with fresh perspectives.

Employee Referral: Leveraging recommendations from current employees to identify potential candidates who are likely a good cultural fit.

Direct Hiring: Filling positions by directly sourcing and selecting candidates without intermediaries, ensuring full control over the recruitment process.

Vendor General Hiring: Engaging recruitment agencies or vendors to source candidates for general roles, offering flexibility and scalability.

Executive Hiring: Targeting senior-level or specialized leadership positions through tailored search processes to find experienced professionals.

It is essential to thoroughly evaluate each channel's effectiveness in meeting talent recruitment goals, considering variables such as cost, quality, and overall impact. The cost of channel hiring is calculated as a percentage of the recruit's salary, varying between 4% and 20% based on the chosen method or combination of channels.

Campus recruitment offers the lowest cost, while executive hiring incurs the highest cost. This percentage is applied to the salary of each new employee joining the organization, ensuring the hiring cost reflects the recruitment method's complexity and scope. The average salary per employee is available as a graph under the Talent Management decision tab.

This methodical approach ensures that each chosen channel effectively supports the organization's recruitment objectives.

Hiring and retrench Units: Participants are responsible for determining the staffing changes for each department and employee level for the current round/year based on the hints from the market outlook and the parameters. This involves deciding whether to hire new personnel, retain current staff, or initiate retrenchment measures where necessary. The goal is to align workforce size with organizational needs effectively.

Vendor Hiring: This section focuses on engaging external vendors to fulfil specific roles or execute projects. Vendor hiring is particularly utilized to bridge the gap between demand and supply in cases where workforce estimation for senior or top management roles falls short. Participants are responsible for determining whether to leverage vendor services to supplement internal capabilities or address specialized requirements that cannot be managed effectively with the existing workforce.

Outsourcing Junior Management

Participants have the option to hire junior personnel as part of a bench hire strategy. These individuals are recruited to be readily available for immediate task assignments as needed, ensuring flexibility in resource allocation and responsiveness to sudden operational demands. Outsourcing junior management is specifically intended to bridge the gap between demand and supply when workforce estimation for junior roles proves insufficient. This section emphasizes outsourcing junior management roles to recruitment agencies.

2.5 Talent Management

Under the talent Management tab, the participants are tasked with decisions on how well they manage the talent by incorporating better training, development opportunities as well as providing equitable compensation and bonus.

Compensation Rating: The participants have to decide on how well they rate their employee compensation on various rating scales such as from five star to one which will decide the compensation. As a rule of thumb 5-star employees get a as per position of range table while 1-star employee hardly gets a hike. The maximum cost in the budget will be employee compensation. The decision has to be tactful based on the retention of employees and cost. The position in range table besides indicates what would be a hike different percentile salaried employees will be offered in a particular star rating.

Ratings	Top Management		Senior Management		Junior Management	
	Current Year	Previous Year	Current Year	Previous Year	Current Year	Previous Year
5 Star ★★★★★	10 %	10%	10 %	12%	5 %	15%
4 Star ★★★★☆	20 %	20%	25 %	25%	35 %	25%
3 Star ★★★☆☆	30 %	30%	40 %	30%	40 %	15%
2 Star ★★☆☆☆	30 %	20%	20 %	20%	10 %	10%

Figure 9 The Talent Management Tab

Bonus Policy: The participants have to decide the bonus for their top performers which would be 5-star and 4-star rated employees. The bonus will increase costs while increasing motivation.

Bonus Policy ?

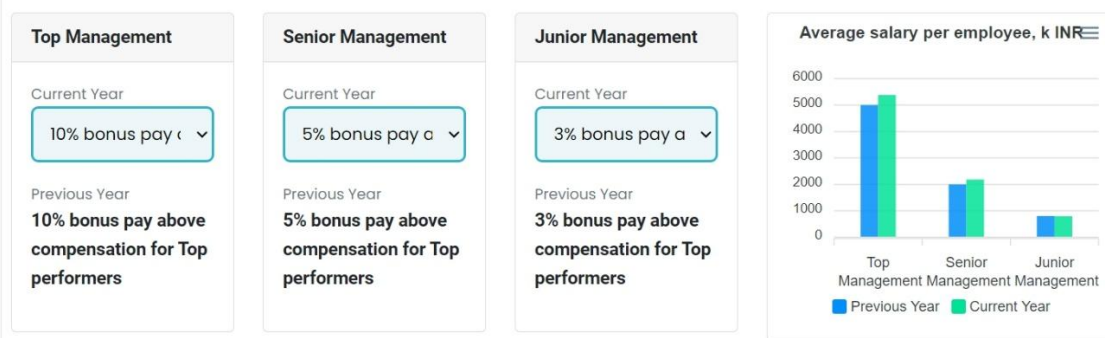


Figure 10 The Talent Management Tab

Pay Cut Decision: The participants have the option to decide regarding a pay reduction, which can range from 6% to 20% of the salary, based on the profiles of the employees.

Payout ?



The interface shows three management levels with "Previous year" and "Current year" decision buttons (Yes/No):

- Junior Management:** Previous year: Yes (green), No (red); Current year: Yes (green), No (red).
- Senior Management:** Previous year: Yes (green), No (red); Current year: Yes (green), No (red).
- Top Management:** Previous year: Yes (green), No (red); Current year: Yes (green), No (red).

Figure 11 The Talent Management Tab

Training: There are 5 options available in training from which participants have to select the appropriate option for each employee profile. While making decision employee time, motivation and needs have to be considered. The cost of each training is different and will be visible in graphs. Short training has the lowest cost and Training as per development plans have the highest cost. The effectiveness of training is in the same manner. Types of training are as under:

- No training
- One short training
- Focused functional training
- Training as needed
- As per personal development plans

Leadership Program: There are various future leadership program options available for junior and senior management. Such initiatives acknowledge employee's potential, providing targeted training to prepare them for promotion to higher positions next year. Each program differs in cost and effectiveness, ensuring a range of development opportunities. These programs not only sustain high internal motivation among employees but also enhance the firm's appeal to new talent.

Policy

Division Policy

These policies are designed to streamline employees' work lives and keep them motivated. Participants can select multiple policies, which apply across the entire organization, each with varying costs and effects on efficiency. Implementation costs will be displayed in tables on the same screen. Adopting these policies enhances employee commitment, strengthens workplace appeal for new hires, and improves overall efficiency.

Diversity & Inclusion Policy

These policies promote a gender-inclusive work environment, aligning with the company's goal of improving the gender ratio and fostering diversity in thought and perspective. Participants can implement multiple policies applicable across the entire organization. Implementation costs will be displayed in tables on the same screen, while policy descriptions will appear on selection cards. Budget trade-offs must be carefully considered to achieve diversity improvements.

Townhall Program

Participants can choose up to three Townhall programs per financial year or round. These programs facilitate communication across teams, provide opportunities to engage with leadership, and enhance cross-functional collaboration. They also raise employees' awareness levels, ultimately improving performance. Implementation costs will be reflected in tables, and program descriptions will appear on selection cards.

2.6 Organization & Budget

In this tab, participants are tasked with implementing appropriate tools and analyse the projected budget for the year.

a. Tools

HR tools are specialized software solutions designed to streamline and optimize various HR functions, enhancing efficiency, decision-making, and overall workforce management. These tools assist the HR team in monitoring performance, tracking recruitment, analysing workforce data, and improving processes. By leveraging these tools, organizations can create a structured and data-driven HR framework, leading to better employee engagement and operational success.

The four key tools available for deployment include:

- **Performance & Goal Measurement Tool** – Tracks employee performance, aligns goals with organizational objectives, and provides insights for continuous improvement.
- **Recruitment Analytics Measurement Tool** – Analyses hiring trends, evaluates recruitment efficiency, and helps improve talent acquisition strategies.
- **Workforce Analytics Measurement Tool** – Provides data-driven insights on workforce trends, productivity, and retention to support strategic HR decisions.
- **Process Content & Guidance Tool** – Standardizes HR processes, offers best practices, and ensures compliance with policies and regulations.

These tools directly impact HR team performance, employee efficiency, and process improvements. **They can be deployed at one of three levels: Base, Intermediate, or Expert.** The total cost of implementing these tools, along with the incremental increase in overall effectiveness, is displayed in a table on the same screen.

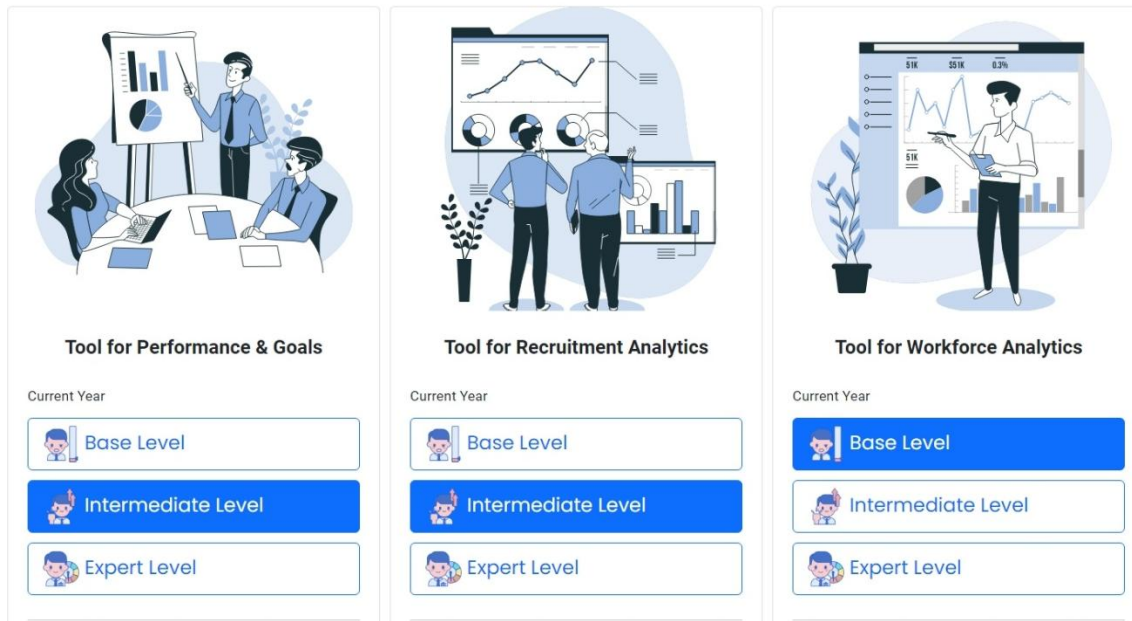


Figure 12 The Organization & Budget Tab

Budget Allocation: To enhance stakeholder satisfaction, effective cooperation between departments is essential. In the event of a budget shortage, funds will be automatically transferred between departments. However, if the budget is not managed efficiently, a budget overrun will be reflected. Additionally, the department exceeding its budget will incur a penalty equal to 20% of its allocated budget.

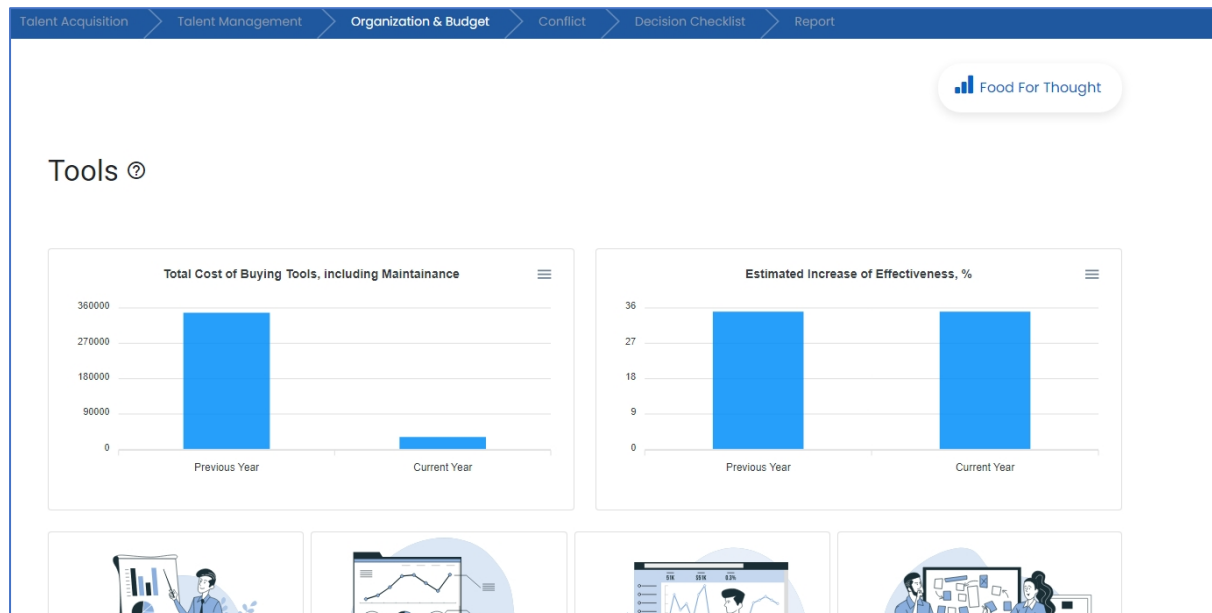
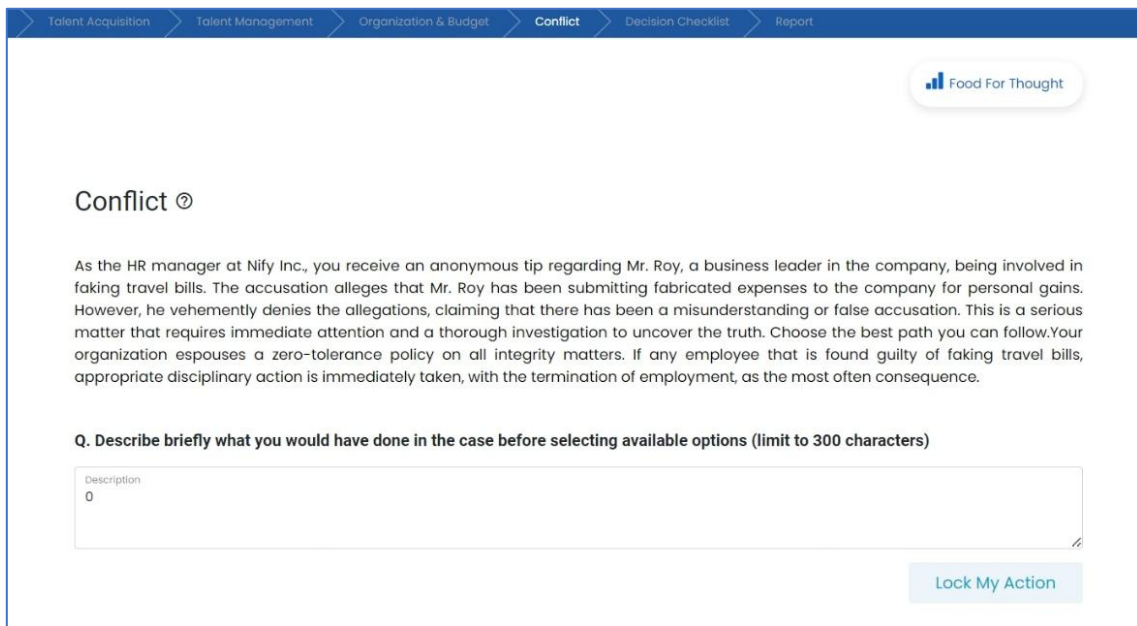


Figure 13 The Organization & Budget Tab

2.7 Conflict

In every round, the participant is presented with a unique case scenario that are related to real professional setting. They are required to provide both subjective answer after carefully considering the scenario, explaining how they will handle the situation if they are one among them. Once they have given their subjective response, the participant can submit it by proceeding to "lock my action." The second step involves selecting appropriate options from a list of choices. The game concludes upon completing these steps.



The screenshot shows the 'Conflict' tab selected in a navigation bar at the top. The navigation bar includes: Talent Acquisition, Talent Management, Organization & Budget, **Conflict**, Decision Checklist, and Report. In the top right corner, there is a 'Food For Thought' icon with a bar chart. The main content area is titled 'Conflict ②'. Below the title, there is a paragraph of text describing a scenario where the HR manager at Nify Inc. receives an anonymous tip about Mr. Roy, a business leader, submitting fabricated travel bills. The text states that the organization has a zero-tolerance policy on integrity matters. Below the paragraph, there is a question: 'Q. Describe briefly what you would have done in the case before selecting available options (limit to 300 characters)'. Underneath the question is a text input field with the placeholder 'Description' and a character count '0'. At the bottom right of the input field is a 'Lock My Action' button.

Figure 14 The Conflict Tab

2.8 Decision Checklist

The Decision Checklist helps participants review and adjust their decisions before the deadline. Once decisions are confirmed, they can submit them using the "Submit" option and choose save and proceed. It is important to remember that once decisions are submitted and saved, they cannot be changed for that round. This ensures that decisions are carefully considered before finalization, promoting clarity and accountability in the decision-making process.

Decision Checklist

Round 1

User

Talent Acquisition, Sales	
Channel Mix 1, Top Management	Executive Hiring
Channel Mix 2, Top Management	Vendor General Hiring
Channel Mix 3, Top Management	-
Channel Mix 1, Senior Management	Direct Hiring
Channel Mix 2, Senior Management	Employee Referral
Channel Mix 3, Senior Management	-
Channel Mix 1, Junior Management	Campus Hiring
Channel Mix 2, Junior Management	Employee Referral
Channel Mix 3, Junior Management	-
Number of hiring Top Management, units	2
Number of hiring Senior Management, units	10
Number of hiring Junior Management, units	57
Number of hiring for Bench Junior Management, units	10
Number of Retrenchment Junior Management, units	3
Number of Retrenchment Senior Management, units	1
Number of Retrenchment Top Management, units	-
Vendor Hiring, Top & Senior Management	Applied
Outsourcing, Junior Management	Applied

Figure 15 The Decision Checklist

2.9 Report

KPI Report

The report section provides the details on how well participant has performed throughout the decision-making process. The reports start with the participants' critical thinking abilities in the food for thought section. The graph adjacent demonstrates on their thought process regarding the "Food for Thought" section.

The **KPI Section** displays key performance indicators, including **employee satisfaction score** and **stakeholder satisfaction score**, based on the participant's decisions. It also presents changes in **performance levels, productivity, and stress levels** across various departments throughout the year. These metrics reflect the impact of decisions made and their corresponding repercussions on the organization.

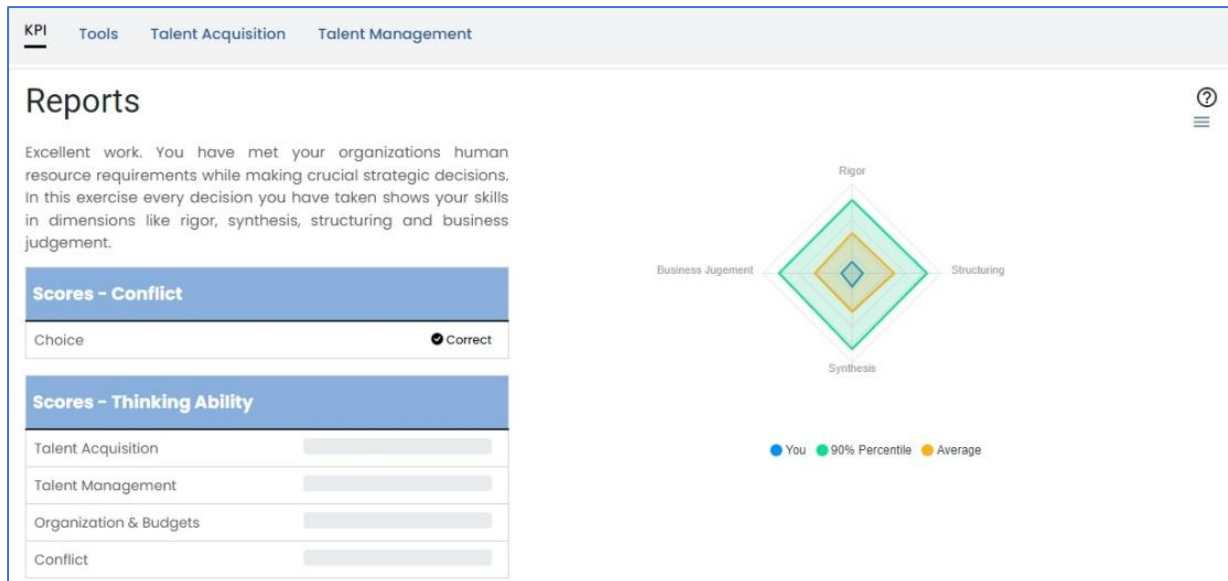


Figure 16 The Report Section



Figure 17 The Report Section

Report on Tools

This section provides detailed insights into the cost of tools, their impact on effectiveness, and their contribution to performance improvement and productivity. It offers a comprehensive analysis of the tools' value in enhancing overall efficiency and organizational success.

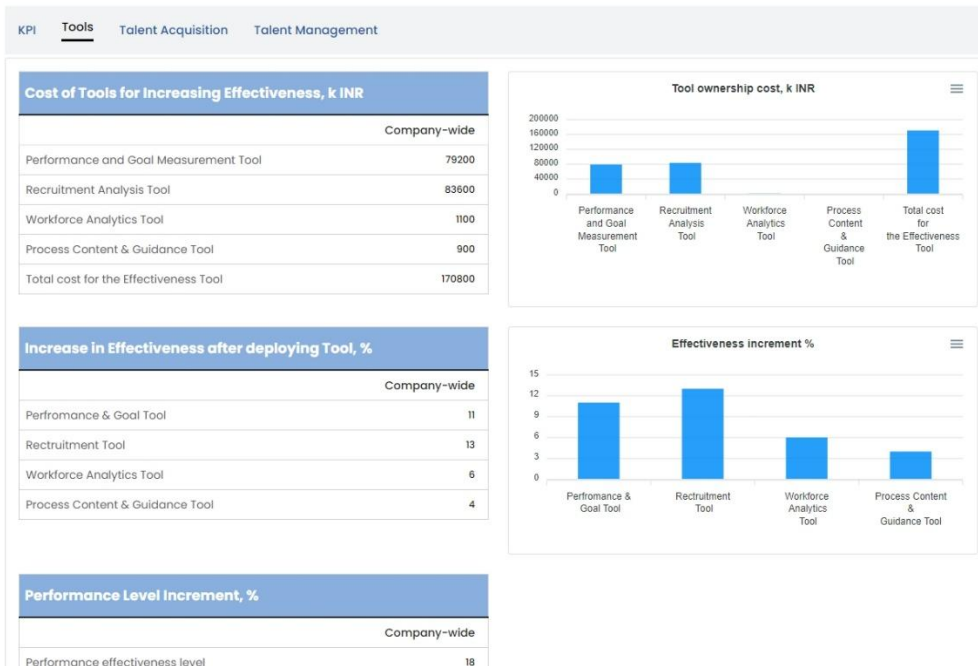


Figure 18 The Report Section

Report on Talent Acquisition

This section provides insights into the impact of talent acquisition decisions on key metrics such as employer branding and recruitment performance. It includes details on workforce size, along with the costs associated with hiring and retrenchment. Additionally, it highlights how implemented policies have influenced the gender diversity ratio within the organization.

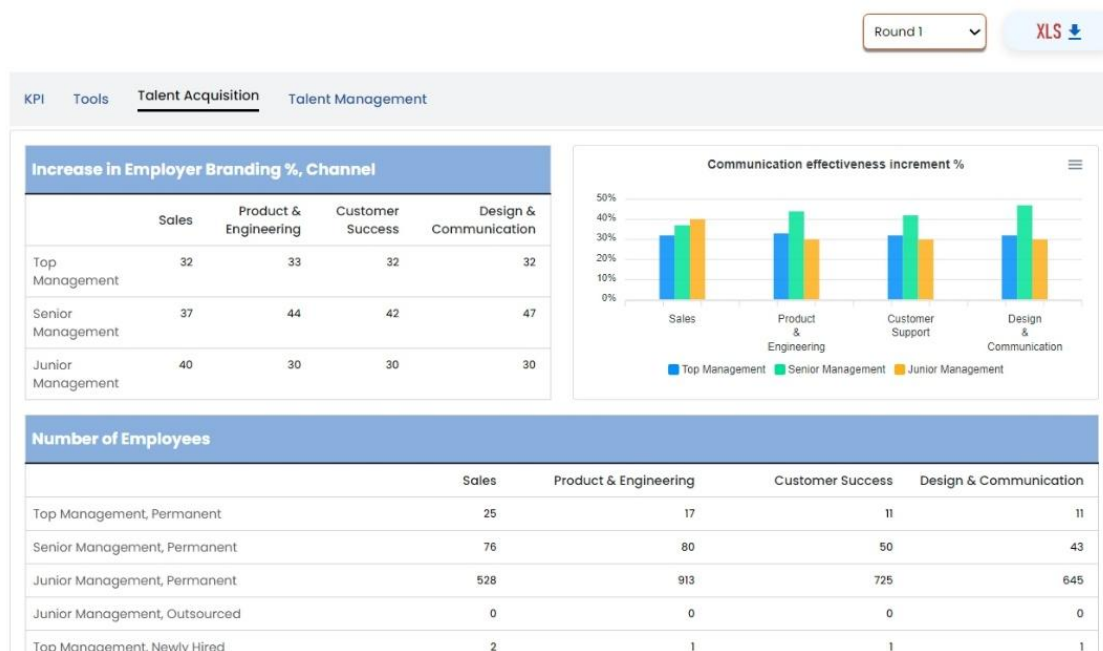


Figure 19 The Report Section

Report on Talent Management

This section provides insights into the impact of talent management decisions on key metrics such as employee awareness, commitment, engagement score, and learning index. It evaluates how these decisions have shaped workforce development and overall organizational growth.

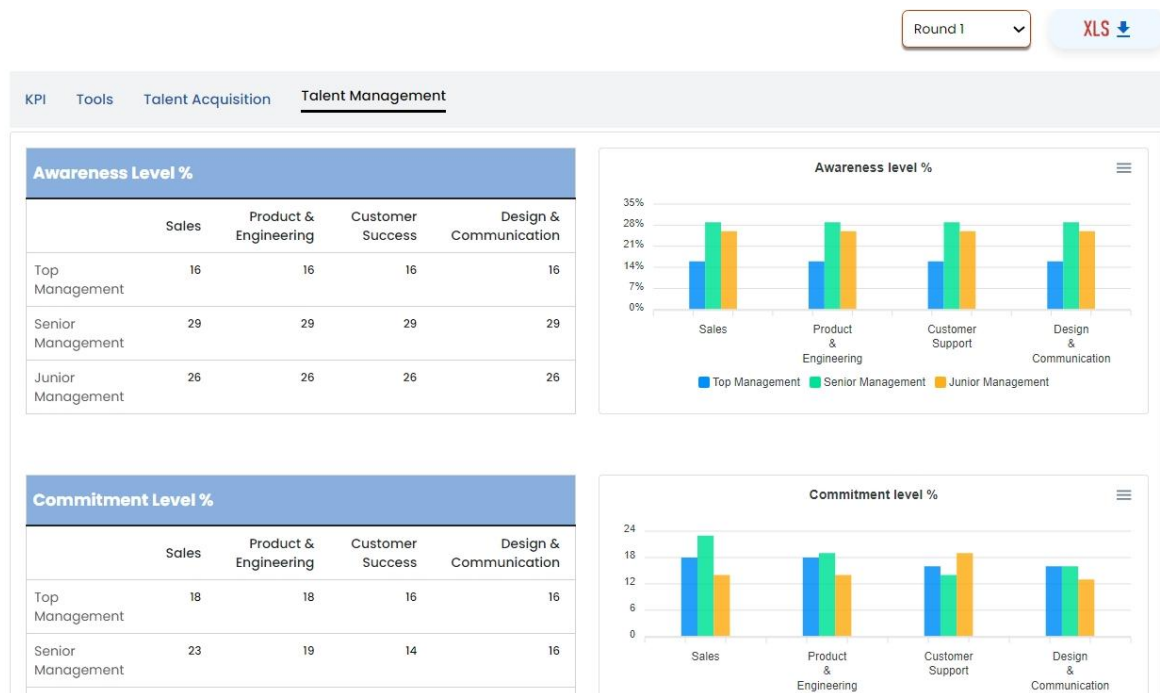


Figure 20 The Report Section

To proceed to the next iteration, participants can click on the designated round mentioned at the end of the report tab.